LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Agriculture, Veterinary and Forestry (Agri-science, Horticulture, Animal Health, Forests): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Observe plants, soil, animals and weather; try gardening, school farm or nature clubs	Interest in life sciences and the environment
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep Science strong; join eco-clubs and Agri / Environment projects	PCB or PCMB in Class 11-12
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose PCB or PCMB (Physics, Chemistry, Biology / Maths) in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for KCET agri seats, ICAR via CUET, NEET (veterinary)
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + KCET (Karnataka agri / horticulture / forestry), CUET-UG (ICAR 15% quota), NEET-UG (BVSc)	Seats at agricultural, horticultural, veterinary and forestry colleges
Degree	After Class 12	BSc (Hons) Agriculture / Horticulture / Forestry, BFSc, BVSc & AH, Agri-business and allied degrees	Professional and research careers
Postgraduate	2-3 years later	MSc Agri, MVSc, MBA Agri-business, PhD, ICAR-JRF	Scientist, officer and entrepreneur roles
Career	-	Agri-officer, scientist, veterinarian, forest officer, agri-entrepreneur	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: start a garden, compost or nature club; observe plants and animals; read about farming and environment.
- Science and Biology interest is the base for later entrance exams.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- PCB or PCMB works for agriculture, horticulture, forestry and fisheries; veterinary needs PCB (NEET).
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- For agricultural universities in Karnataka (UAS Bangalore, UAS Dharwad, UHS Bagalkot, KSNUAHS Shivamogga): KCET (PCMB) with KEA counselling for the state quota, and CUET-UG (ICAR) for the 15% all-India quota.†
- For veterinary (BVSc & AH): NEET-UG merit, per the Veterinary Council of India.

After Class 12: Degree

- BSc (Hons) Agriculture, Horticulture, Forestry, Sericulture, Fisheries (BFSc), Agri-business Management, Food Technology; BVSc & AH for veterinary.

After the degree: Career

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- Government and bank agri-officer posts, ICAR and state research, seed and agri-input companies, forest services (state and IFoS), veterinary practice, dairy and fisheries, farming and agri-start-ups.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Eco-clubs, nature camps, school gardens	Schools, forest departments, NGOs	6-12	Builds interest and observation	Through the year
Science olympiads / NSO	SOF and others	1-12	Biology and Science practice†	See Science PCB document
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: agriculture and veterinary are science-based professions. Keep PCB marks healthy and visit a farm, nursery or veterinary clinic with your child.

4. Entrance exams and services

ICAR UG admission via CUET-UG	
Conducting body	NTA for ICAR (all-India quota); counselling at icarcounseling.com†
Used for	15% all-India quota seats in about 13 UG programmes (including BSc (Hons) Agriculture) across about 74 ICAR-accredited agricultural universities; this replaced the stand-alone AIEEA UG
Eligibility	Class 12 with required subjects (PCB / PCM / Agriculture combinations); each university sets details†
Pattern	CUET-UG; 50 MCQs per domain subject, 60 minutes, +5 / -1 (see Science documents)
Timing	CUET May-June; ICAR counselling July-September†

KCET - Karnataka agriculture, horticulture and forestry	
Counselling body	Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA); universities: UAS Bangalore (GKVK), UAS Dharwad, UHS Bagalkot, KSNUAHS Shivamogga
Rule	State quota (85%) via KCET + KEA counselling; merit uses KCET marks with qualifying PCMB marks; 15% via ICAR (CUET). KCET 2026: 23-24 April, results 6 June†
Forestry	BSc Forestry at colleges in Sirsi and Ponnampet; sources conflict on the parent university (Shivamogga vs Dharwad)†

BVSc & AH (Veterinary) via NEET-UG	
Rule	Veterinary Council of India: admission on NEET-UG merit rank, no other weightage; 15% all-India quota by VCI counselling; state quotas follow
Eligibility	10+2 with Physics, Chemistry, Biology / Biotechnology; minimum 50% aggregate (47.5% for SC/ST and special categories)†
Duration	About 5 years including internship†

Indian Forest Service (IFoS) and forest services	
Conducting body	UPSC (IFoS); state forest departments recruit Range Forest Officers
Eligibility	Bachelor's degree including one of Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Science, Botany, Chemistry, Geology, Mathematics, Physics, Statistics or Zoology, or a degree in Agriculture, Forestry or Engineering; age 21-32 as on 1 August (relaxations vary); attempts General 6, OBC 9, SC/ST unlimited†

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Note	IFoS prelims is the same as the Civil Services prelims; mains is separate†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Fisheries (BFSc), Dairy Technology, Sericulture, Food Technology, Agri-business Management	Allied agri fields	Entry through KCET / CUET / university tests; Karnataka BFSc details not found†
Agricultural Diploma / Polytechnic	After Class 10	See Polytechnic and ITI document†
Agri-entrepreneurship, farming, organic and precision agriculture	Self-employment	Training via KVKs, universities and start-ups†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
ICAR AIEEA PG / CUET-PG	NTA / ICAR	MSc Agri, MVSc	Once a year†
ICAR-JRF / SRF	ICAR	PhD funding	Once a year†
UPSC IFoS / UPSC CSE, state PSC and agri-officer exams	UPSC / states	Services	Yearly†
NABARD, banks and agri-business MBA tests	Various	Rural banking and agri-business	Yearly†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
ICAR and university scholarships; state agricultural university scholarships	ICAR, universities	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each university†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences; some agriculture-science degrees may qualify.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc (Hons) Agriculture	4 yr	KCET (state) / CUET-ICAR (15%)	Largest agri degree
BSc (Hons) Horticulture	4 yr	KCET / CUET-ICAR	UHS Bagalkot and others
BSc (Hons) Forestry	4 yr	KCET / CUET-ICAR	Sirsi, Ponnampet; forest services
BFSc (Fisheries)	4 yr	State / ICAR route†	Aquaculture and fisheries

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Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BVSc & AH	About 5 yr	NEET-UG	Veterinary practice; VCI registration
BTech Agricultural Engineering / Food Technology	4 yr	KCET / JEE / CUET†	Engineering in agri sector

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): UAS Bangalore (GKVK), UAS Dharwad, UHS Bagalkot, KSNUAHS Shivamogga, College of Forestry Sirsi and Ponnampet, KVAFSU Bidar (veterinary, fisheries)†, ICAR institutes (IARI, IVRI).†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Agriculture and horticulture	Agri-officer, agronomist, horticulturist, farm manager, extension officer	MSc, MBA Agri-business, PhD
Veterinary and animal sciences	Veterinarian, livestock officer, dairy and poultry specialist, researcher	MVSc, PhD
Forestry and environment	Forest officer (RFO / IFoS), wildlife biologist, environmental consultant	MSc Forestry, IFoS exam
Agri-industry	Seed, fertiliser, food-processing and agri-tech roles; NABARD and bank officers	MBA Agri-business
Entrepreneurship	Farmer, agri-start-up founder, organic and export farming	Training and incubation

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCB: biology research, biotechnology and NEET (see Science PCB document).
- Health and Allied: veterinary overlaps with biomedical research (see Health and Allied document).
- Skills and Entrepreneurship: agri-start-ups and skill training (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).
- Civil services: IFoS and state agri / forest services (see Arts and Humanities document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Agriculture, Veterinary and Forestry

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Eco-club, garden, nature camps; keep Science strong
After Class 10	Choose PCB or PCMB; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + KCET, CUET-UG (ICAR), NEET-UG (veterinary)
After Class 12	BSc Agri / Horticulture / Forestry, BFSc, BVSc & AH
Postgraduate	MSc Agri, MVSc, MBA Agri-business, ICAR-JRF, PhD
Career	Agri-officer, scientist, vet, forest officer (RFO / IFoS), agri-entrepreneur

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
KCET (Karnataka)	April (2026: 23-24)	PCMB; state quota 85% via KEA	No negative
CUET-UG (ICAR)	May-June†	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min; 15% all-India quota	+5 / -1
NEET-UG (BVSc)	May (2026 re-exam: 21 Jun)	180 Q, 720 marks; VCI merit rank	+4 / -1
IFoS (UPSC)	Yearly	Prelims + Mains + Interview; degree in listed subjects	Check notification

Key rules: BVSc needs NEET and 50% PCB; Karnataka agri seats use KCET (PCMB); ICAR gives 15% all-India quota via CUET.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), ICAR / university scholarships.†

Careers: agri-officer, scientist, veterinarian, forest officer, agri-entrepreneur.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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